

1958 The IC Arrives



A part of the SAGE A/N FSQ -7

January: A computerised network for defence

SAGE (Semi Automatic Ground Environment), the first computerised air defence network, was set up in the United States. SAGE was conceived to provide an early warning against incoming long-range Soviet bombers. The SAGE centres were connected by telephone lines, and each was built around the IBM's A/N FSQ-7 computer, which incidentally is the largest (it weighed 275 tons and occupied half an acre) computer ever built. The A/N FSQ-7 was based on MIT's Whirlwind II. By the time SAGE was completed in 1963, it was practically redundant as the Soviet Union deployed ICBMs as the primary long range delivery platform for nuclear weapons. However, the engineering effort behind the project was huge and the experience gained in systems integration was vital when the ARPANET was later built. SAGE was dismantled in 1983.

February: And DARPA is established

DARPA (Defence Advanced Research Projects Agency) was established in February. Its mission was to conduct R&D into futuristic technologies. Its creation was hastened by the Sputnik launch; the